

AYURVEDA DIETETICS PROGRAM

Report
2020-2024

**MADE POSSIBLE
BY**



RIST
RURAL INDIA SUPPORTING TRUST

We gratefully acknowledge the funding support
provided by RIST for seeding and nurturing the
Ayurveda Dietetics program at TDU

FOREWORD

The Ayurveda Dietetics program was conceived in March 2020, with the primary objective of providing authentic information on food concepts in Ayurveda. It was targeted at nutritionists and dieticians, and developed based on workshops that were held with the Indian Dietetic Association (IDA)-Bangalore and IDA-Mysore Chapters. The COVID-19 pandemic moved it online, where it has remained since, morphing from a 10 hour introductory course into a 1 credit-15hr introductory course, 2 credit-30hr advanced course, 1 credit-15 hr Applied Nutrition course, 6-hr Udemy course offered online, and a 1 credit-30hr internship offered offline. We also offer bespoke courses for academic institutions and have launched a school nutrition outreach module for adolescents.

Our biggest differentiator from others in the field is our steadfast commitment to authentic, verifiable information. We engage with renowned ayurvedic practitioners and present ayurvedic concepts in the light of modern food science, physiology and nutrition knowledge. We are proud to bring a trans-disciplinary perspective to food science that combines traditional and modern science.

We are grateful for the support from Rural India Supporting Trust (RIST) for helping to seed and nurture this initiative, with special thanks to **Dr. Gurmeet Singh**, whose leadership provided a conducive environment for constantly experimenting with content and delivery. We would also like to thank all the physicians who have delivered lectures and colleagues at TDU for improving our content. Last, but not least, our participants deserves thanks for their feedback and questions which continue to strengthen our course material.

While the courses have attracted yoga teachers, food enthusiasts and other knowledge-seekers, this course is TDU's effort to build human resource capacity amongst nutrition practitioners. For it is only with professionals that we can begin to test if and how the integration of these concepts would be beneficial in wellness and illness.

FOREWORD

A combination of the individualized Ayurvedic approach and generalized modern dietary practice can be transformative in our quest to improve the personalization of healthcare.

In the next leg of our journey, we hope to launch studies to build the evidence base for Ayurveda dietetics in contemporary health management. We invite all stakeholders - physicians, scientists, practitioners, and volunteers - to evolve dietetics into a science that combines traditional knowledge, culture, food science and health.



Megha, PhD
Associate Professor,
Program Coordinator, Ayurveda Dietetics
Program
August 2024

August 2024

PROGRAM OVERVIEW

EDUCATION

► Introduction to Ayurveda Dietetics

This course is a basic introduction to Ayurveda and the eight principles that form the framework of Ayurveda dietetics. The Ayurvedic vocabulary to describe the body, mind, and food is explained. Further considerations for personalizing the diet, such as season, quantity, food combinations, and dietary practices, are discussed. At each step, where applicable, a modern nutrition science perspective is provided. Through the examples of pregnancy, iron-deficiency anemia, cognition, and diabetes, integrative dietetics is illustrated. A participatory pedagogy model is adopted so that learning is engaging and participants feel encouraged to apply their knowledge. A 90-page training manual has been developed to complement the lectures.

► Advanced Ayurveda Dietetics

This advanced course is conceived as the next step to the introductory course and focuses on dietetics for clinical use. It is targeted specifically at practitioners: clinical dietitians and physicians. The course is divided into two parts. The first part deals with theoretical concepts concerning food and treatment in Ayurveda. The second part consists of master classes by experienced Ayurvedic doctors (*vaidyas*), who discuss dietetic interventions for specific health issues like digestive problems, diabetes, and heart disease. Their insights and intimate knowledge provide participants with tools to apply in their clinical practice. Real-world examples and case studies make the application of concepts easier to grasp, allowing participants to learn firsthand about personalizing diets for various health conditions.

PROGRAM OVERVIEW

► Seminars

Various seminars are conducted based on participant requests and contemporary needs. Topics: Ghee and Buttermilk, Home Health Medicinal Plants, Virudha Ahaar, Agni and Ama for well-being, AI Tools in Ayurvedic and Modern Nutrition Research, Ayurveda Food Concepts for Modern Dietitians, Kitchen Pharmacy, Skin Health, Ayurveda Food Biology, and Ayurveda Biology of Nutrition.

► School Outreach

This module is for early adolescents to make healthier food choices through fun, hands-on activities. Children explore traditional tastes, learn about nutrients, diverse diets, and identify ultra-processed foods. A teacher training manual and booklet for children has been developed.

RESEARCH

► Cancer Research Project

As part of an ongoing observational study on outcomes associated with Ayurveda interventions in cancer patients, a dietary study component has been initiated. The diet study seeks to explore the association, if any, between systemic metabolic status (Agni), diet diversity (DQQ score), and a diet that integrates ayurvedic and modern nutrition concepts.

EVOLUTION

2019: FOUNDATION YEAR

- August: First program with IDA-Bangalore Chapter (47 participants)
- November: Symposium on Ghee and Buttermilk (37 participants)
- October: Workshop on Home Health Medicinal Plants, TDU (13 participants)

2020: EXPANSION AND ENGAGEMENT

- Introduction to Ayurveda Dietetics [IAD] Workshop: Conducted for IDA Mysore, Bangalore, and Kerala (98 participants)
- June to December: Intro to Ayurveda Batches (139 participants)
- Webinar on Viruddha Aahar (43 participants)
- Ghee Seminar (38 participants)
- November: Advanced Ayurveda Dietetics: 2-credit course (22 participants)

2021: CONTINUED GROWTH

- IAD upgraded to 1-credit certificate course.
- February - November: Introduction to Ayurveda Batches with a total of 164 participants. Three special sessions with IDA Indore, Rajasthan and Kerala.
- March, December: Advanced Ayurveda Dietetics (39 participants)

SPECIAL EVENTS

- May-June: Introduction to Ayurveda Biology of Nutrition (29 participants)
- April : Webinar on Agni & Ama for well-being (20 participants)
- July: 1st Anniversary Celebration: Recipe crafting event (81 participants)

2022: SUSTAINED INTEREST

EVOLUTION

- February, March, June, July, November: Introduction to Ayurveda Batches (96 participants).
- AAD upgraded to 2-credit certificate course.
- RAV accreditation for IAD.

2023: TEAM GROWS AND RESEARCH

- February: Expanded the team with Dietitian Sonia Velarsan coming on board.
- January, March, June, July, September: Introduction to Ayurveda Dietetics Batch (121 participants)
- Advanced Ayurveda Dietetics 2023: 2-credit course and select topics (52 participants)
- Diet study in cancer patients initiated

SPECIAL EVENTS

- May: Skin Health by Dr. Shashidhara (36 participants)
- August: Kitchen Pharmacy by Dr. Madhumitha Krishnan (28 participants)
- October: Webinar on AI Tools in Ayurvedic and Modern Nutrition Research by Dr. Prasanna Kulkarni (303 participants)
- December: Ayurveda Food Concepts for Modern Dietitians by Registered Dietitian Sonia (247 participants)

2024: EXPANDED PROGRAM OFFERINGS

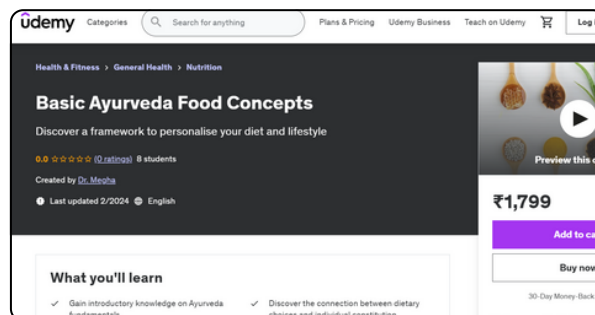
- February: 6hr “Ayurveda Food Concepts” launched on Udemy
- February, May, July: Introduction to Ayurveda Dietetics Batch (168 participants)
- April: Advanced Ayurveda Dietetics 2024: 2-credit course and select topics (51 participants)
- June: 1 credit Applied Nutrition Science launched (32 participants)
- July: 1 credit Internship in Ayurveda Dietetics launched (3 participants)

NEW INITIATIVES

- School outreach program, Jan 2023 & Jan 2024:



- Udemy Course: A comprehensive 6-hour online course, May 2024



- Applied Nutrition Science Course: Recently launched with 50 participants, June 2024



- Internship in Ayurveda Dietetics: A new program providing hands-on experience in the field.



BESPOKE COURSES:

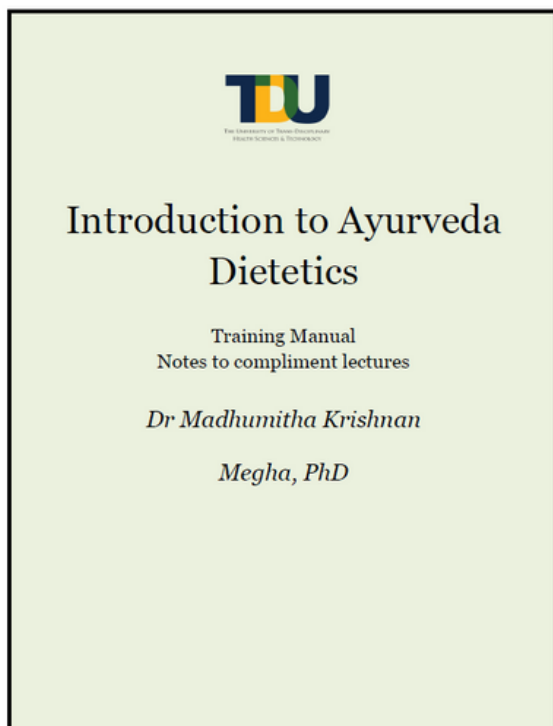
- December 2019: Workshop on Ayurveda Food Biology: Organized for IDA members at their annual meeting.
- May - June 2021: Introduction to Ayurveda Biology of Nutrition: Held for Mount Carmel College, Bengaluru (41 participants).
- May 2021: Ayurveda Biology of Dietetics: Hosted for St Joseph's College for Women, Alappuzha, Kerala with 39 participants.

Indian Dietetics Association (IDA) Workshop:

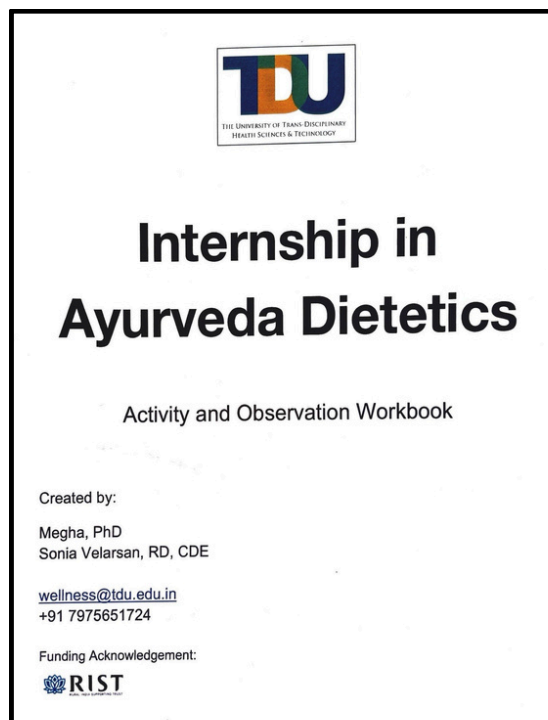
- March 2020: IDA Mysore (~100 participants).
- July 2020: IDA Bangalore (48 participants).
- November 2020: IDA Kerala (24 participants).
- January 2021: IDA Indore (9 participants).
- May 2021: IDA Rajasthan (49 participants).



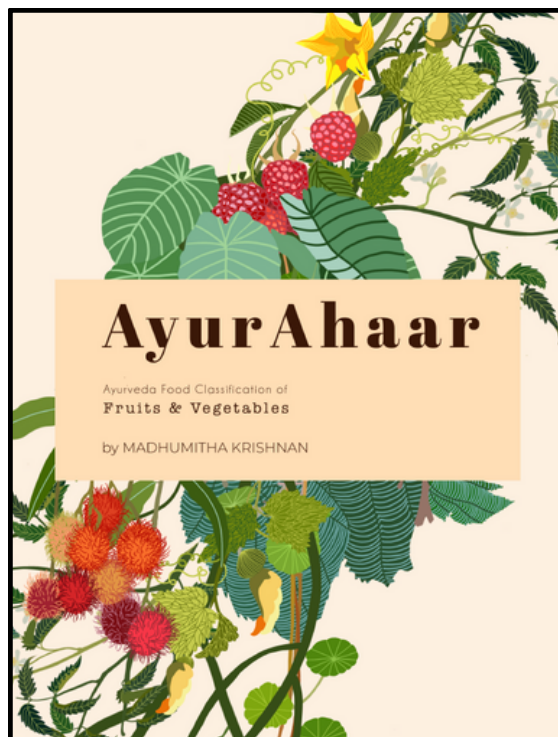
RESOURCES GENERATED



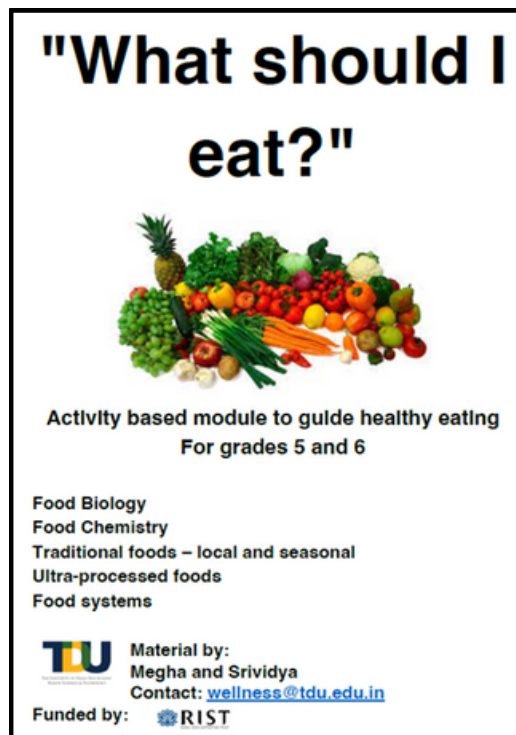
Training manual



Workbook



Rasapanchaka book



Guide for Healthy Eating

OVERALL PARTICIPATION

A total of **1,850** participants have registered for various programs and webinars, with close to ~1,000 participants specifically enrolling in our introductory and advanced Ayurveda Dietetic courses. Among these, **60%** are dietetic/nutrition professionals, while the remaining **40%** include yoga practitioners, Ayurveda doctors, and food enthusiasts.

Among the participants, we began compiling a list of those who have been members of the IDA since 2023. So far, we have counted 208 IDA members amongst our participants.

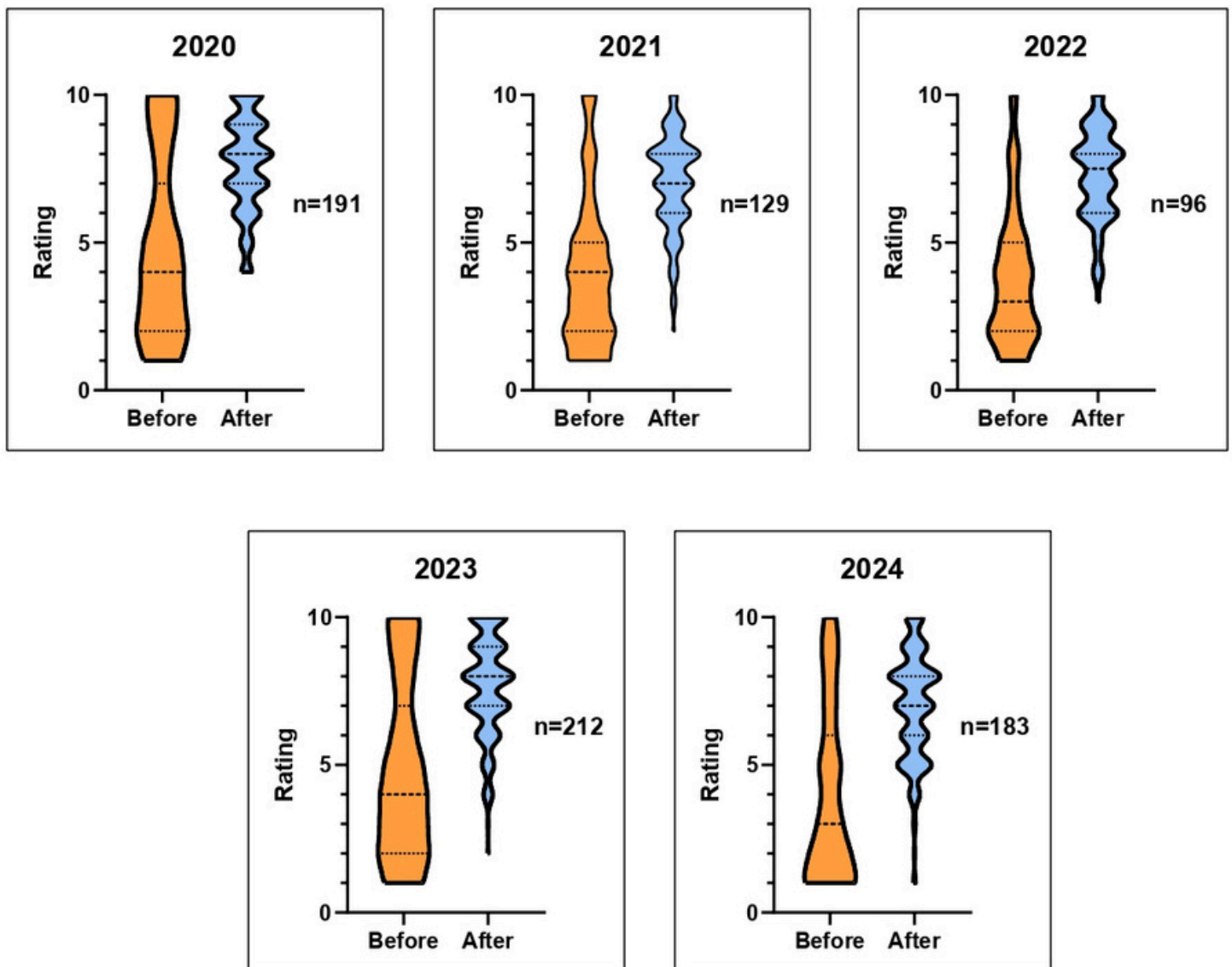


IMPACT

IMMEDIATE COURSE FEEDBACK

After each course, we asked participants to evaluate the content, course delivery and pedagogy. Selected feedback data from each year is shown below.

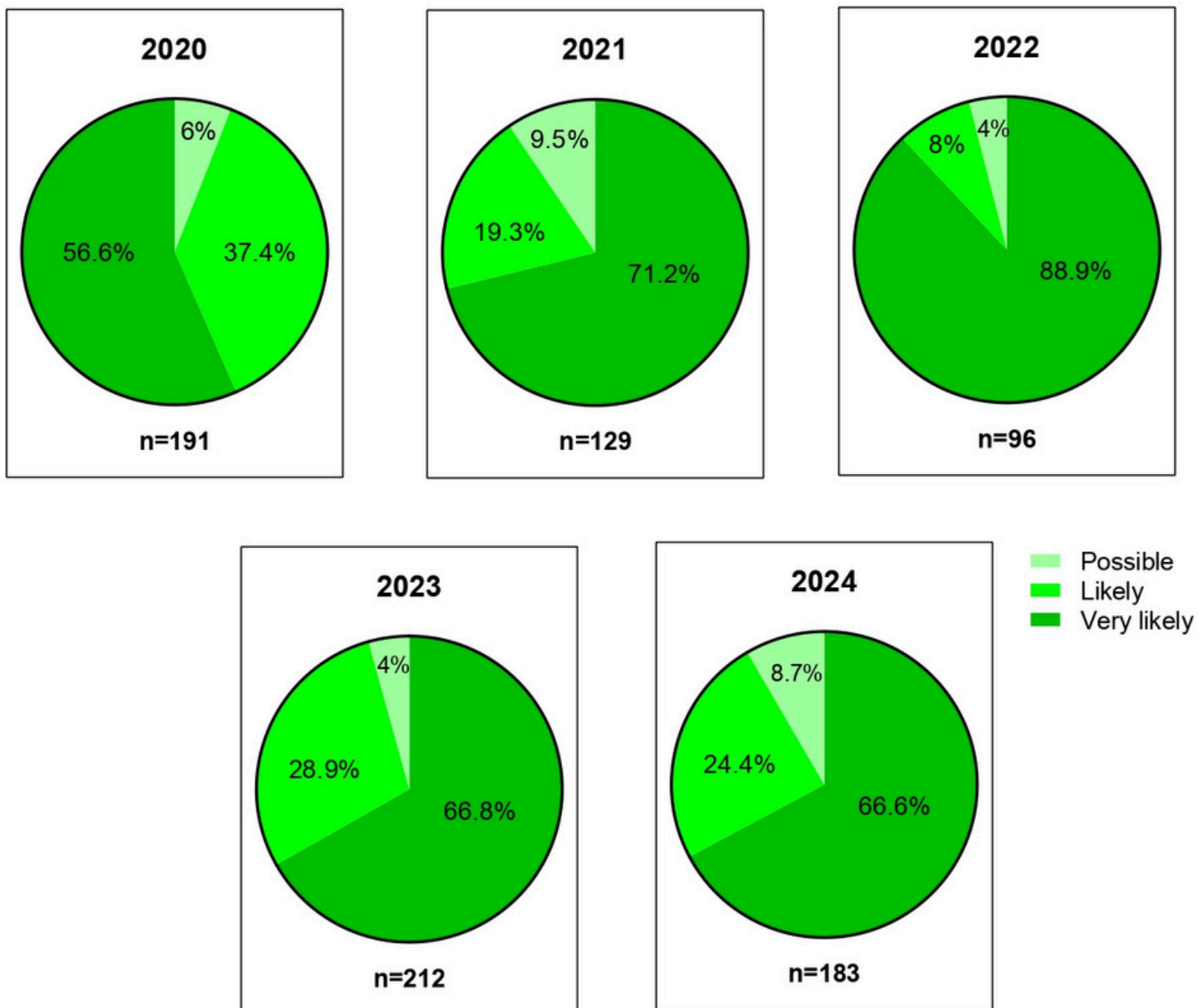
Knowledge level (self-rating out of 10)



On average, 76% increase in knowledge

IMPACT

We also asked our participants how likely they would be to recommend this course to their peers, on a scale of 1-5, with 1 reflecting "not likely" and 5 reflecting "most likely".

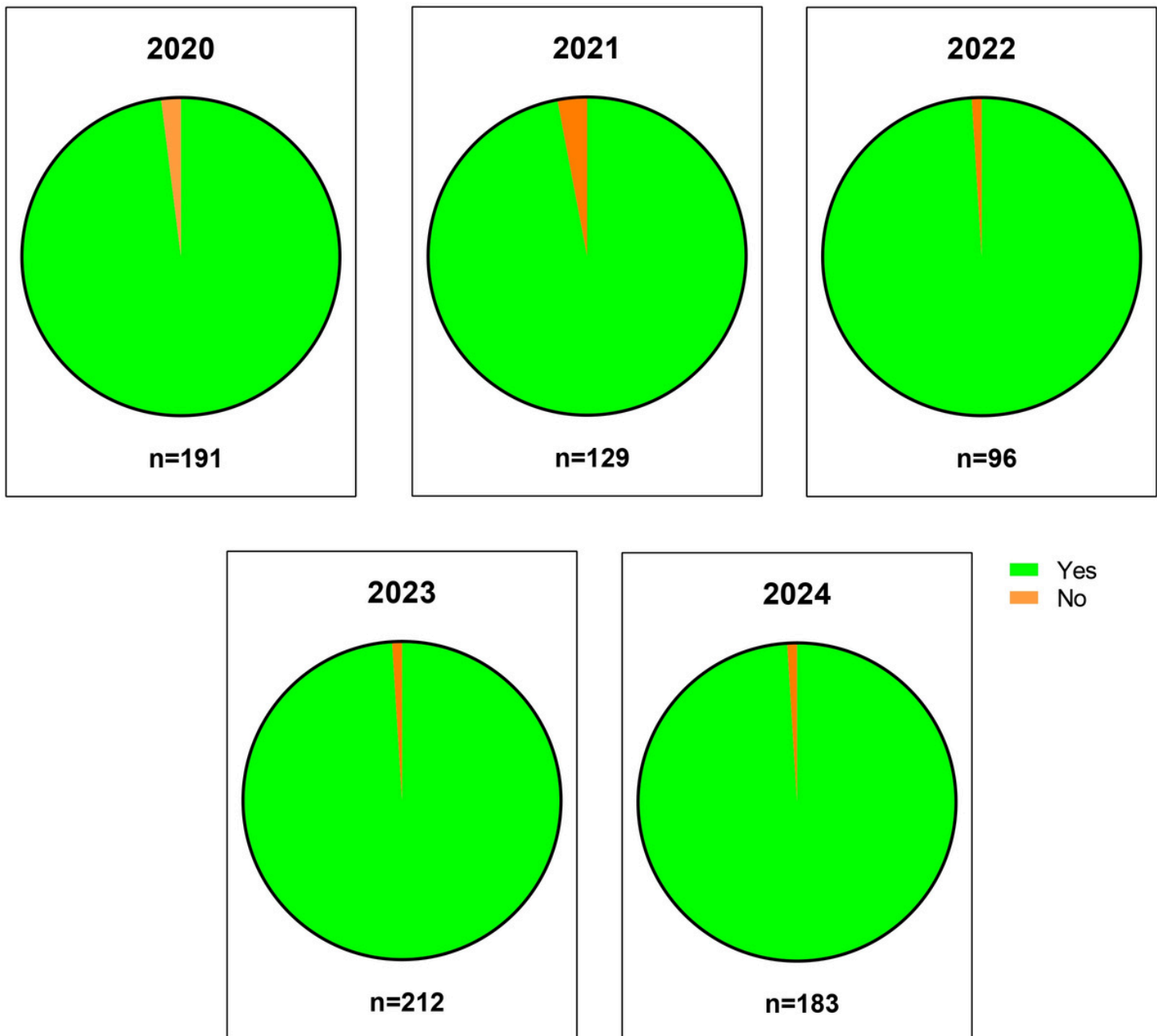


> 85% likely to recommend this course to their peers

IMPACT

We also asked the participants whether they found this course worth the amount paid?

Selected feedback data from each year is included here.



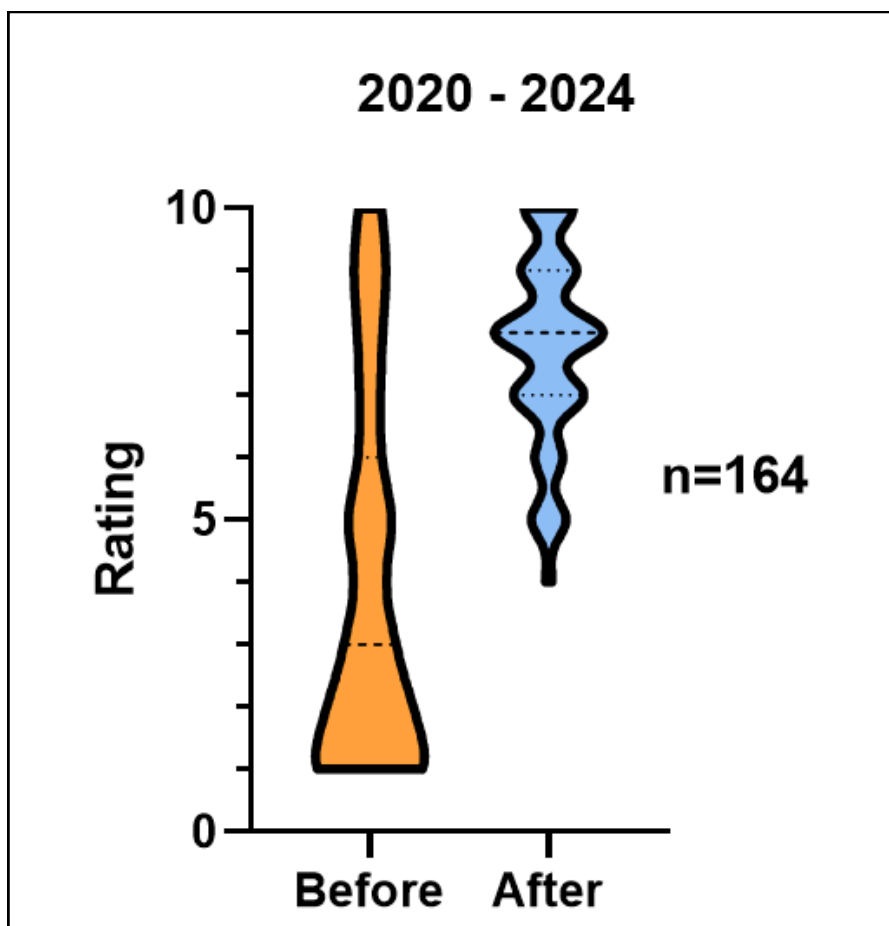
> 95% felt the course provided value for money

IMPACT

ADVANCED AYURVEDA DIETETICS

After each course, we requested participants to assess their understanding of *pathya* (wholesome diets) in disease management. This summary includes combined data from 2020 to 2024.

Knowledge of *pathya* in disease management



~ 93 % increase in knowledge of Clinical Ayurveda Dietetics

DIPSTICK

POST COURSE FEEDBACK

Like any science, practicing Ayurveda Dietetics requires a practitioner to mature and hence, we reached out to participants 1-2 years after completion to understand how they were using it in their practice. Of those who agreed to be polled, ~ 50% were using the material at least occasionally. For those who consented (15), we spoke at length 1:1 and amongst other things, asked them the concepts they utilized the most. These are listed below.

**Eating according
to *doshas***

Viruddha aahar

***Agni* concept**

**Specific spices and
ingredients for *doshas***

***Rashi* concept**

***Rasa* concept**

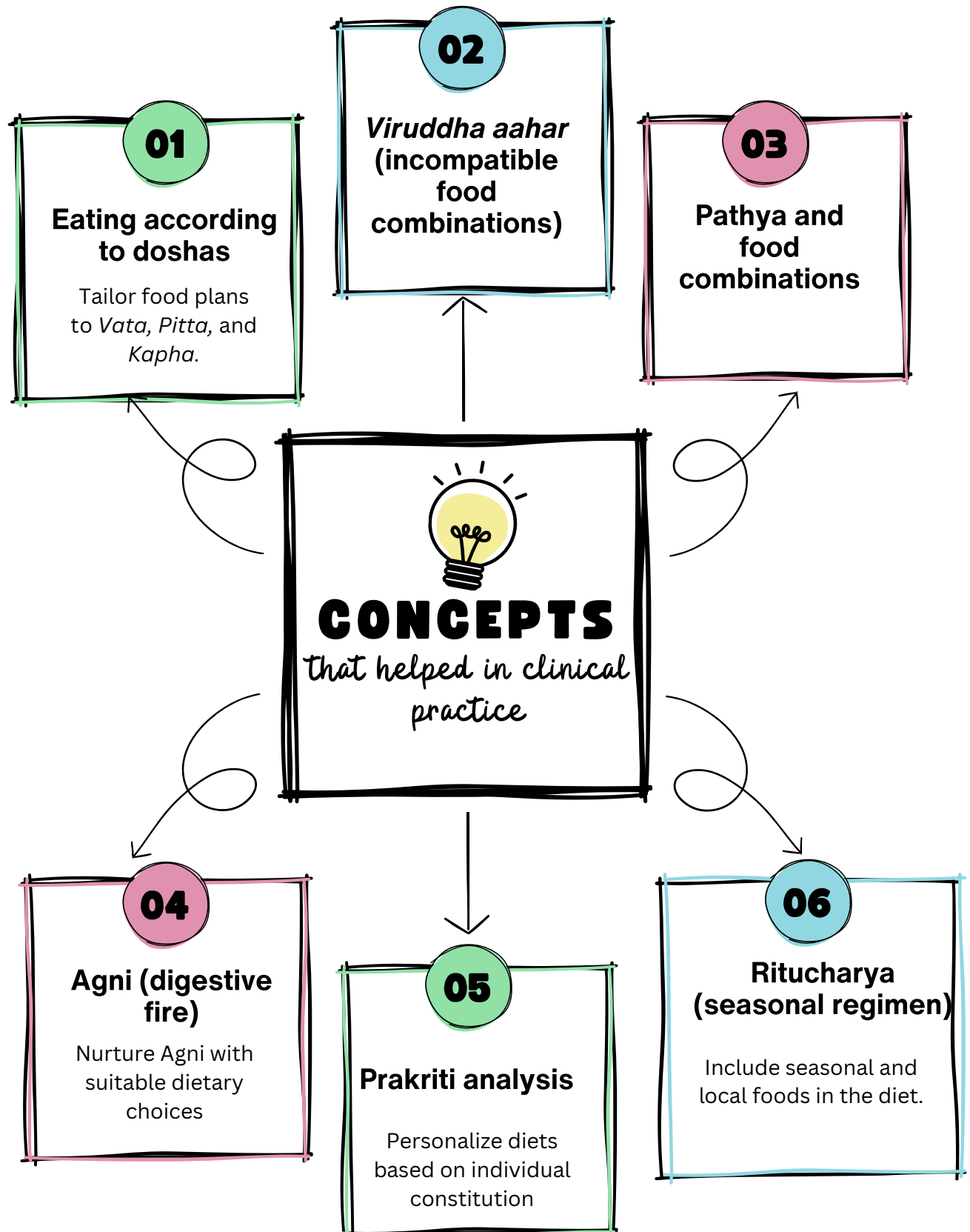
***Karna* concept**

***Desha* concept**

DIPSTICK

We asked **dietitians** which concepts they are advising their patients to incorporate, revealing diverse applications of Ayurveda Dietetics in clinical settings.

Number of participants who spoke on call (n): 15



FUTURE DIRECTIONS

The Ayurveda Dietetics Program started with the aim of creating awareness about authentic Ayurvedic food concepts, and their relevance to contemporary nutrition science and dietary habits. Because the concepts resonate with Indian traditional food practices and involve ingredients that are both easily available, and culturally relevant, the acceptance of these concepts is high. However, it would be nice to understand the real-world effectiveness of these dietary principles both in wellness and illness contexts, using molecular biomarkers and controlled studies. Hence, **in the next 5 years we would like to address the research gap in Ayurveda Dietetics.**

Ideas include:

Population-level studies:

- Conduct large-scale research studies to gather comprehensive data on the efficacy of Ayurvedic dietary practices.

Evidence-based dietary recommendations:

- Develop dietary guidelines backed by clinical evidence that combine Ayurvedic principles and nutrition science.

Standardize protocols for clinical dietetics:

- Establish and implement standardized protocols for Ayurvedic dietetics in hospitals to ensure consistent and effective dietary practices.

**We welcome Clinical Dietitians to join
our research program!**

**You can contribute to the research from
the city you're located in.**

Write to us: wellness@tdu.edu.in

FLYERS



TDU ... 10 DAY ONLINE COURSE ...

Introduction to Ayurveda Dietetics

An academically intense course on Ayurveda food principles for modern diets

 24 Feb 2025 - 07 Mar 2025
4:00 PM - 5:30 PM IST (Mon-Fri)

Course Instructors

- Dr. Madhumitha Krishnan, **MD Ayurveda Vaidya**
- Dr. Megha, **PhD Biochemistry**

Program Asst.

- Ms. Sonia Velarsan, **RD**

 wellness@tdu.edu.in
 +91 7975651724
(WA anytime, Mob- 10am - 6pm M-F)

Get 20% off when 3+ students join! Pay only ₹1770 each.

₹ 3540
Students ₹2250

SPECIAL DISCOUNT

MORE INFO
SCAN ME



Introduction to Ayurveda Dietetics

FLYERS

Introduction to Ayurveda Dietetics Lesson Plan

#	Content	In-class	Self-study
1	- TDU & course overview - Introduction to Ayurveda - Upayoktha - 8 Principles - Panchamahabhutatvas - Prakruti of an individual		Assignment # 1: Prakriti self-assessment TD article
2	- Modern dietetics vis a vis Upayoktha - Prakruti and genomics - Note about shastras - Prakruti of food	Assignment # 1 discussion	Quiz # 1 Genomics & Prakriti paper
3	- Rasa - Ayurveda & modern perspective - Guna - Ayurveda & modern perspective	Rasa-Bhuta Poll Guna poll	Frontiers PH article
4	- Virya, - Virya: Paper discussion - Vipaka, Karma - Modern classification of foods	Rasa game	Quiz # 2 Hot & cold foods article
5	- Prakruti of a person and diet - Karana - Ayurveda & modern perspective - Samyoga, Nitya Sevaniya ahara,		Dairy products article Ultra processed foods: Hall paper
6	- Desha - Ayurveda & modern perspective - Kala - Ayurveda & modern perspective	Desha game	Ritucharya Game
7	- Rashi - Ayurveda & modern perspective - Upayoga Samstha - Upyokatha for modern times - Integrative Ayurveda Dietetics	Make it Shadrasa game	Quiz # 3 Assignment #2:
8	- Swasthya - Viruddha Ahaar - Terms in Ayurveda Physiology: Agni, Dhatu Poshana, Pachana, Mala - Fasting, milk substitutes, millets	Agni game	
9	Integrative dietetics: 1st 1000 days		Quiz # 4 Design-a-diet
10	- Integrative dietetics: Diabetes - Assignment # 2 discussion		Quiz # 5 Feedback Crossword Escape Room

Introduction to Ayurveda Dietetics

FLYERS



6th Batch

ADVANCED

अ्युरवद

DIETETICS

21 Apr - 12 June, 2025

4:00 - 5:30 PM IST

2 Credits Online
Certificate Course

OR

Pay-per-session for
masterclasses

6500/-

360/-

REGISTER NOW



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Advanced Ayurveda Dietetics

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Course Curriculum

Suitable for nutritionists, dietitians, Ayurveda doctors, biomedical scientists, yoga professionals seeking knowledge on food in Ayurveda

Advanced Ayurveda Dietetics: Units 1, 2 & 3,
2 credit certificate course
Eligibility: "Introduction to Ayurveda Dietetics" or B.A.M.S

Masterclasses: Units 2 & 3, pay-per-session
Eligibility: All knowledge-seekers with basic Ayurveda proficiency

Unit 1 Theoretical Concepts in Ayurveda Relevant to Clinical Dietetics

Unit 2 Ayurvedic Culinary Aspects

Unit 3 Masterclasses by Vaidyas

Access to recordings till July 12, 2025



Advanced Ayurveda Dietetics - Unit 2 & 3
19 May - 12 June, 2025

Masterclasses

4:00 - 5:30 PM* IST (Mon, Tue, Thu)

These sessions are designed for those with formal training in Ayurveda

Unit 2

Unit 3

1 Ahara Vargas
Vd. Madhumitha Krishnan
MON 19.05.25

2 Rasayana foods
Vd. Subrahmanya Kumar
THU 22.05.2025

3 Ayurvedic Cooking
From Shastras to Kitchen
Vd. Shridevi Gothe
SAT 24.05.25

4 Diabetes (Retinopathy)
Vd. Prasanna Kulkarni
MON 26.05.2025
8:00 - 9:30 PM

5 Cancer Dietetics -
Managing Palliative care
Vd. Prasan Shankar
TUE 27.05.25

6 Managing acid reflux,
bloating and constipation
Vd. Shankar
THU 29.05.25
6:00 - 7:30 PM

7 Fibroids and painful
period management
Vd. Aswini Mohan
MON 02.06.25
6:00 - 7:30 PM

8 Intermittent Fasting for
Metabolic Health
Dt. Jyoti Arora
TUE 03.06.25

9 Management of
Psoriasis
Vd. Shashidhara
THU 05.06.25

10 Chronic Kidney
Disease
Vd. Rakesh Nair
MON 09.06.25

11 MASLD (NAFLD) and
MASH (NASH)
Vd. Neetu Mohan
TUE 10.06.25
5:30 - 7:00 PM

12 Autism Spectrum
Disorders
Vd. Madhumitha Krishnan
THU 12.06.25

Join any session at ₹360/session or get all 12 for ₹3,600!

*Some timings are different. See course schedule
Access to recordings till 12 July, 2025

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Advanced Ayurveda Dietetics Masterclass

FLYERS



ayurveda

Dietetics Internship 2024

An internship program aimed at professional development to gain practical experience in Ayurveda Dietetics

1 credit course

Program Benefits

- Obtain practical experience in Ayurveda clinical dietetics
- Shadow Ayurveda doctors
- Create integrated diet charts
- Observe diverse cases and real-life treatment

Program Requirements

- ✓ Completed 'Introduction to Ayurveda Dietetics' from TDU with Grade C and above AND
- ✓ Completed B.Sc. Nutrition and Dietetics/ Home Science/ allied subjects relating to healthcare
- ✓ OR Completed BAMS or any UG degree with subjects related to health or food science

To apply, candidates who are interested, fill this form: <https://bit.ly/3V07khZ>

✉ wellness@tdu.edu.in
 ☎ +91 7975651724
 (WA anytime, Mob- 10am - 6pm M-F)

- On-site program
- Hostel facility available (inclusive of food)
- Travel facility available
- Training manual provided

🌐 [Website link](#)



COURSE PLAN

Day 01

Day 02

Day 03

Day 04 & 05

Day 06

Ayurveda hospital setup

- Introduction to program objectives, logistics, and physician mentors, followed by a hospital tour.
- Overview of Panchakarma therapy basics, dietary management for patients, and diet planning concepts covering macronutrients and food formats.

Diet planning concepts

- Dive into diet planning concepts: 24-hour recall, key considerations, and diet design.
- Practical cancer project/case study.

Campus walk

- Visit to Scientific Kitchen and Herbarium.
- Medicinal plants tour
- Adapting classical recipes for modern practice

Case studies

- Observe inpatient and outpatient care at the Ayurveda Hospital.
- Prepare diet charts for patients encountered in OPD/IPD

Assessment

- Discuss prepared diet charts with physicians and communicate with clients.
- Viva voce, program feedback, and certificate award.

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Internship in Ayurveda Dietetics

TEAM



Dr. Madhumitha Krishnan
BAMS, MD
Lead Instructor



Megha, PhD
Associate Professor, TDU
Program founder and coordinator



Ms. Sonia Velarsan
RD, CDE
Program Assistant

BLOGS PUBLISHED

- Drumstick (Moringa) - An Ingredient as Food and Medicine
- Citron fruit (Kanchikai) - An Ingredient as Food and Medicine (Part 1 &2)
- Kapittha (Wood Apple) - An Ingredient as Food and Medicine
- Pippali - An Ingredient as Food and Medicine
- Jamun - An Ingredient as Food and Medicine
- Karonda - An Ingredient for Food and Medicine
- Ginger - An Ingredient for Food and Medicine
- 3 ways to incorporate Ayurveda Dietetics in Everyday Life
- The choice of cooking methods
- Satvik, rajasik, and tamasik foods, would it be easier if redefined for modern times?
- Pentasure Hepatic in Milk vs Buttermilk: An Ayurvedic and Scientific Perspective
- Beating the Common Cold: Kitchen Pharmacy
- Food Combinations to Avoid: Viruddha Aahar & Modern Chemistry
- Unripe Jackfruit: Culinary Potential & Health Benefits
- The Sweet Dilemma: Deciding on the Perfect Summer Fruit
- Beyond Sweet and Salty: The importance of including bitter and astringent in our daily diets
- Manathakkali / Kakamachi: An Unsung Hero Among Green Leafy Vegetables!
- Does Ayurveda say 'NO' to most foods?
- Blog on Cooking Rice - Ayurveda Culinary Workshop Series

INVITED SPEAKERS



Dr. Sankaranarayanan.S
MD (Panchakarma)



Dr. Aswini Mohan L
BAMS, MS (Ay), YIC



Dr. Yashaswini G
BAMS, MD



Dr. Prasan Shankar
Medical director, BAMS, MD



Dr. Narendra Pendse
BAMS, MD



Dr. Girish Kumar
BAMS, MD



Dr. Vikram Balu
BAMS, MS



Dr. Shashidhara
BAMS, MD



Dr. Subrahmanya Kumar
BAMS, MD, PhD

INVITED SPEAKERS



Dr. Sanketh Sharma
BAMS, MD



Dr. Mangalagowri V Rao
BAMS, MD



Dr. M.R. Vasudevan
Namboothiri
Medical director, BAMS, MD



Dr. Rashel Miracle Rego
BAMS, MS



Dr. Prasanna Kulkarni
BAMS, MD

The University of Trans-Disciplinary Health Sciences and Technology



© This report has been prepared for Ayurveda Dietetics Program at The University of Trans-Disciplinary Health Sciences and Technology, Bangalore.

📍 Post Attur via Yelahanka, Jarakabande Kaval, 74/2, Post Attur via Yelahanka, Jarakabande Kaval, Bengaluru, Karnataka 560064

✉ For more details email: wellness@tdu.edu.in
For courses visit: www.tdu.edu.in